Phishing Awareness Training

CodeAlpha Cyber Security Internship

Task 2

Stop • Check • Verify

What is Phishing?

Phishing is an attempt to trick people into revealing sensitive information.

Attackers may use emails, messages, or fake websites.

The goal is often to make the victim trust a fraudulent request.

How Phishing Attacks Work

1. Attacker creates a deceptive message
2. Message creates urgency, fear, curiosity, or a reward
3. Victim is directed to a link, attachment, or request
4. Victim may be asked for information or to take an unsafe action

Common Types of Phishing

Email phishing — deceptive emails

Smishing — phishing through text messages

Fake websites — websites designed to imitate legitimate services

Spear phishing — targeted and personalized phishing attempts

Warning Signs of Phishing Emails

Unexpected or unfamiliar sender

Urgent or threatening language

Suspicious links or unexpected attachments

Requests for passwords or other sensitive information

Spelling, grammar, or unusual formatting

Messages that seem too good to be true

How to Identify Fake Websites

Check the website address carefully

Look for unexpected or misleading domains

Do not ignore browser security warnings

Avoid entering sensitive information after following an unexpected link

Open the official app or website yourself when in doubt

Social Engineering Tactics

Urgency — “Act now!”

Fear — threats of suspension or account loss

Authority — pretending to be a trusted person or organization

Curiosity — tempting links or attachments

Rewards — fake prizes, offers, or benefits

Real-World Style Scenario

Example message:

“Your account requires immediate verification. Please use the provided link.”

Red flags:

- Unexpected request
- Urgency
- Link asking for account action

Safer response: independently open the official service and verify the message.

Interactive Quiz

You receive an unexpected message asking you to log in using a link. What is the safest action?

A) Click the link immediately

B) Reply with your password

C) Open the official app/site independently and verify

D) Forward the message to friends

Correct answer: C

Prevention & Conclusion

Think before you click.

Verify unexpected requests through an independent channel.

Use strong, unique passwords and enable MFA where available.

Keep software and browsers updated.

Report suspicious messages to the appropriate organization.

STOP • CHECK • VERIFY